



# Early race cars

Some early race cars had a **mechanic** onboard to make repairs.

*Small, round windshield known as a monocle*



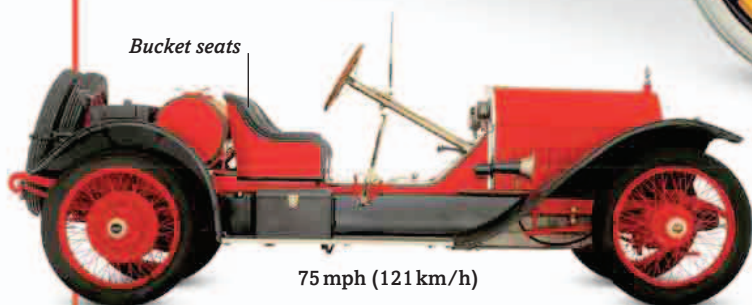
85 mph (137 km/h)

**Lancia Tipo 55 Corsa**  
Italy 1910



80 mph (129 km/h)

**Mercer Type 35R Raceabout** USA 1910



*Bucket seats*

75 mph (121 km/h)

**Stutz Bearcat** USA 1912

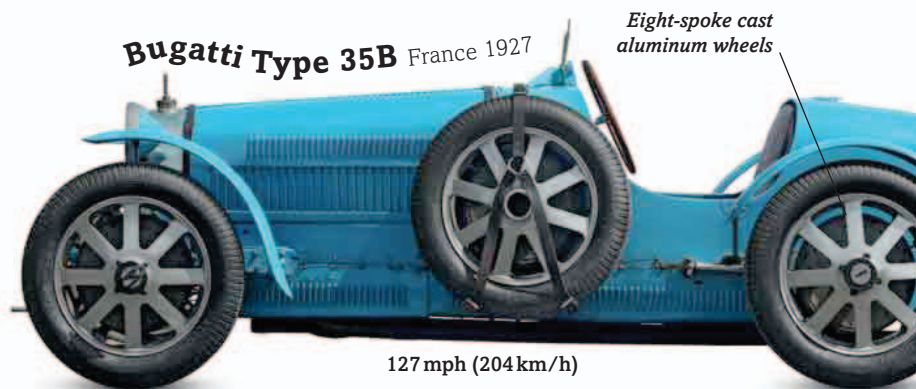
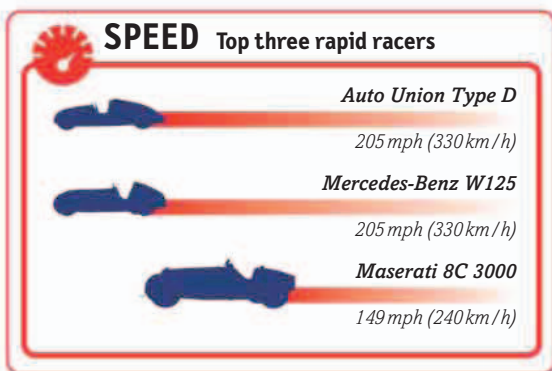


*Starting handle turns to fire up engine*



**Duesenberg 183** USA 1921

112 mph (180 km/h)



**Bugatti Type 35B** France 1927

*Eight-spoke cast aluminum wheels*

127 mph (204 km/h)

As soon as cars were mass produced, people became eager to race them. Early racing tested speed as well as reliability, since early cars broke down a lot. But advances in technology quickly saw race cars develop into speed demons.

Some early race car drivers turned into car builders. Italy's Vincenzo Lancia, who won the 1904 Coppa Florio race, manufactured the **Lancia Tipo 55 Corsa**. Across the Atlantic, the **Stutz Bearcat** won 25 of the 30 races it entered, while the **Mercer Type 35R Raceabout** won